

with the number of awesome Star Wars quotes, and the passible passwords that can be made from them, just know that you are safe!

We still have not addressed how to be wary of shoulder surfing and phishing. To counter those, the best way is to be more careful of your surroundings and ensure the authenticity and security of the websites where you enter your personal data. For shoulder surfing, there is one trick that can make your password difficult for a casual observer to guess: Use a double character in your password. If a password has a character repeated twice, it will be difficult for an observer to notice the repetition since your fingers won't move from the key. If you type your password fast enough, most people won't be able to detect a character pressed twice.

Another common flaw in most people's password policy is to use the same password for all their accounts. This is quite understandable, most people have a large number of accounts, and it would be difficult to remember a unique password for all. You can however put a little extra effort to make data at least a little bit more secure. For one, you can choose different passwords for your more important accounts such as online banking and lesser important ones such as the website accounts you may have created just to leave comments. This way, even if you password on one of the less secure websites is cracked, your important accounts will be secure.

Another thing you can do is to choose a base password and modify it depending on the website you are using. If your base password is "x#f33todr" you can create a Facebook password of "Fx#f33todrb" or something similar. If you maintain the same pattern everywhere your password will be easier to remember. However it will also be easier to guess for someone who knows your trick – but you won't tell anyone will you?

Passwords are the fragile little things holding our online life and the security of our organizations together. They are the short character sequences that lie between us and total destruction. Keeping a secure password is very important, and it is equally important to understand how you might be at risk. I hope that this section has been of help.

Next, we talk about Hashes, the short character sequences that strive to keep our password secure despite adversity.

2.2 Hashes

2.2.1 What the #!

When we open an account with any service provider, we are first of all giving them the password to our data. What happens then if a disgruntled employee leaks this data, or if the account data is exposed in case of software vulnerability?

The problem with passwords is that somewhere or the other you need to store the damn thing just so you can access it later on to authenticate a login